

A U X & V I S U A L D E S I G N R E P O R T

The Royal Mughal Palace Digital Wedding Invitation



Burgundy Velvet · Antique Ivory · Gold Detailing · Candlelit Luxury

The feeling before the pixels

Design Philosophy & Mood

This is not a "website with a countdown" — it is a **digital haveli door** that swings open for every guest. The entire experience should feel like walking through a candlelit palace corridor at night: heavy velvet drapes, warm brass light pools, gold filigree catching the light, and hushed, ceremonial pacing. Every section is a "room" the guest is invited into, revealed one at a time rather than dumped on screen at once.

CORE MOOD

Cinematic & Ceremonial

Slow, confident motion — nothing snaps or bounces cheaply. Every transition should feel like a curtain, a door, or a page of an old manuscript turning. Think a film's opening title sequence, not a SaaS landing page.

MATERIAL LANGUAGE

Velvet, Metal & Parchment

Three "materials" recur everywhere: **velvet** (deep burgundy gradients with soft vignettes), **gold metal** (thin hairline borders, foil-stamped headings, embossed icons) and **parchment/ivory** (card surfaces, texture grain, warm paper shadow).

ORNAMENT VOCABULARY

Arches, Jali & Filigree

Recurring motifs: the pointed Mughal arch (used as a frame for the hero and venue cards), the jali lattice (used as subtle background texture), corner filigree flourishes, and a thin double-line gold border ("picture frame" treatment) around key content blocks.

LIGHT

Candlelit, Never Flat

Avoid flat solid fills. Every burgundy surface carries a soft radial "candle glow" — warmer and lighter toward one edge, fading to near-black at the corners — so the screen always feels lit from within rather than printed.

Guiding Principles

- **One hero moment, not many.** The opening animation is the emotional peak — everything after it should feel like a graceful continuation, not a competing spectacle.
- **Restraint on gold.** Gold is a detail colour (borders, icons, type accents) — never a large fill. Let burgundy and ivory carry the weight; gold should glint, not shout.
- **Mobile is the only canvas.** Every measurement, tap target, and animation timing in this report assumes a portrait phone viewport (375–430px width). There is no desktop fallback to compromise for.
- **Performance discipline.** Rich visuals must still open on a mid-range phone at a wedding venue with patchy wifi — motion is built from lightweight SVG/CSS/Lottie, not heavy video loops.

The palette, materials and type that hold everything together

Colour Palette

Burgundy Deep
#3D0F1C

Burgundy Velvet
#5C1A2B

Burgundy Bright
#7A1F35

Antique Ivory
#F6EEDF

Parchment
#EDE0C8

Antique Gold
#C9A227

Gold Highlight
#E8C874

Candle Glow
#FFB74D

Usage rule of thumb: 60% burgundy (backgrounds, hero, section dividers) · 25% ivory/parchment (card surfaces, readable text blocks) · 10% gold (borders, icons, headline accents) · 5% candle-glow amber (glows, hover/tap states, particle effects).

Typography System

DISPLAY / NAMES

Playfair Display

Used for the couple's names, section titles, and the invitation headline. High-contrast serif strokes read as "engraved gold" when combined with a subtle gold gradient text fill and soft drop shadow.

SCRIPT ACCENT

Cormorant Garamond Italic

Used sparingly for connecting words ("&", "requests the pleasure of your company", dates written in longhand) — gives a hand-lettered, invitation-card warmth without a full script font's readability risk.

BODY COPY

EB Garamond

All paragraph text, schedule details, venue descriptions. Warm, legible old-style serif that keeps the "printed invitation card" feeling even in body copy.

CALLIGRAPHIC MOTIF

Islamic Calligraphy Ornament

A single decorative calligraphic mark (e.g. an ornamental Bismillah motif, rendered as artwork/SVG rather than a live font) appears once — at the very top of the opening animation — as a blessing before the invitation unfolds. It is treated as an illustration, not body text.

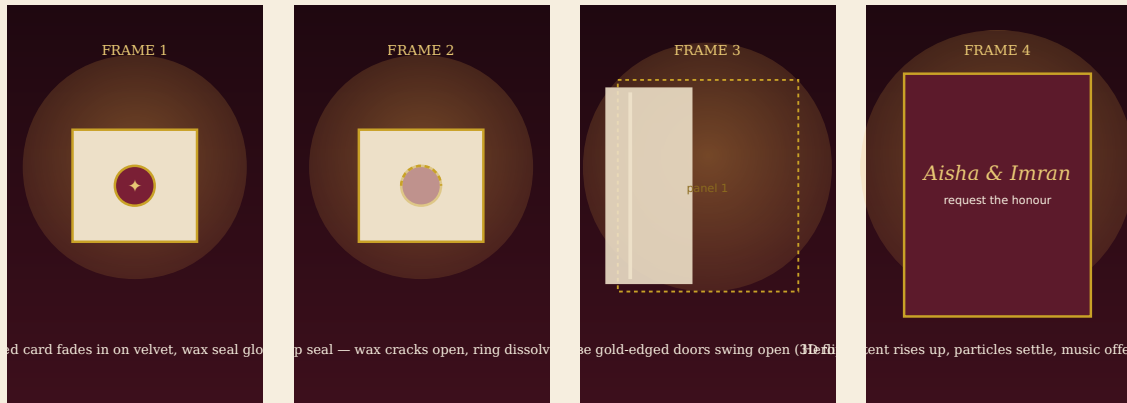
Type Scale (mobile)

Role	Font	Size	Weight / Style
Couple names (hero)	Playfair Display	34-40px	600, gold gradient fill
Section headings	Playfair Display	22-26px	600, ivory or gold
Script accents	Cormorant Garamond Italic	16-19px	500 italic
Body / descriptions	EB Garamond	15-16px	400, 1.6 line-height
Labels / eyebrow text	EB Garamond	10-11px	500, letter-spacing 2-3px, uppercase

The single most important 6 seconds of the entire site

Opening Invitation Animation

Concept: "The Sealed Royal Envelope." The guest does not land on a scrollable page — they land on a closed, wax-sealed invitation card centred on a black-velvet backdrop. They must (lightly) participate to open it, which turns a passive page-load into a ceremonial moment.



Opening sequence storyboard — four beats, roughly 5–6 seconds total

Beat-by-beat sequence

- **0.0s - Black velvet fade-in.** Screen opens on a near-black burgundy vignette with a single soft candle-glow radial light pulsing gently at 4s intervals (this pulse continues under everything).
- **0.3s - Card materialises.** An ivory invitation card with a gold hairline border scales in from 92%→100% opacity+scale, centred, with a small embossed wax-seal medallion (monogram of the couple's initials) at its centre. A short line of ornamental calligraphy fades in above it.
- **0.8s - "Tap to open" cue.** A thin gold ring slowly draws itself around the seal (SVG stroke-dashoffset animation) with a small label beneath in tracked-out caps: "Tap to Open Your Invitation." This is the only required interaction in the whole animation.
- **On tap - Seal cracks.** The medallion scales down and fades with a light gold particle burst (12–16 small dots, 400ms), a soft "seal break" sound plays if audio is enabled, and haptic feedback (light impact) fires on supporting devices.
- **+0.4s - Palace doors open.** Two vertical gold-bordered panels (representing the two halves of the invitation) rotate open on their outer edge in 3D (perspective transform, 700–900ms, ease-in-out), revealing deep burgundy behind them, like double doors swinging into a lit hall.
- **+0.9s - Hero rises.** The names, ornamental divider, and "the wedding of" label rise up individually (staggered 80–120ms each) with a slight blur-to-focus effect, while faint gold particle motes drift upward slowly in the background and continue looping.
- **+1.4s - Settle.** Motion settles; the scroll cue (a slim animated down-arrow inside a gold lantern-shaped icon) fades in at the bottom; background music quietly begins if the user opts in.

Build note: implement with GSAP or Framer Motion timelines driven off one master sequence; the "door" panels and particle bursts are lightweight SVG/CSS, not video, so the animation stays under ~300KB and runs at 60fps on mid-range phones.

How the palace corridor unfolds as the guest scrolls

Scroll Animation System

Concept: **"Walking down a lit palace corridor."** Instead of independent per-section pop-ins, the whole page should feel like one continuous, gently moving corridor — background jali patterns and candle-glow spots drift slowly (parallax), while content "rooms" (sections) reveal themselves as the guest arrives at each one.

Layer	Behaviour on scroll	Speed / Easing
Background jali lattice texture	Moves ~30% slower than foreground content (parallax drift), tiles seamlessly top to bottom	Linear, tied to scroll position
Candle-glow radial spots	2-3 fixed soft amber glows per section, subtly shift position and opacity as section enters/leaves viewport	ease-out, 1.2s per glow shift
Section content blocks	Fade + rise 24px on enter (IntersectionObserver, trigger at 20% visible), staggered per child element	cubic-bezier(0.22,1,0.36,1), 600-800ms
Ornamental divider between sections	Gold line "draws" itself left-to-right (stroke animation) as it enters view	ease-in-out, 900ms
Section arch frame (venue cards, schedule)	Arch outline traces in first, then inner content fades in after arch completes	sequential, 500ms + 500ms
Gold particle motes	Continuous slow upward drift throughout, density very low (10-14 particles), never pauses	looping, 8-14s per cycle, randomised

Section-to-section transitions

- **Countdown → Invitation message:** the countdown's glow softly dims and the message card "opens like a folded letter" — a subtle CSS 3D unfold (top half rotating down from a center fold) triggered once, on first entry only.
- **Invitation message → Event schedule:** a thin gold timeline thread draws downward from the divider and becomes the spine of the schedule's vertical timeline, visually stitching the two sections together.
- **Schedule → Venue cards:** venue cards slide in from alternating left/right edges with a soft arch-shaped mask reveal (clip-path animating from 0 to full arch), reinforcing the "walking past palace archways" feeling.
- **Venue → Actions row (map / calendar / share):** icons scale in with a small bounce-free "settle" (scale 0.9→1, 400ms) rather than a full section reveal, since this is a utility row, not a ceremonial one.

Motion restraint rules

- No section should animate more than once per visit (use `triggerOnce`) — re-triggering on scroll-up/down feels gimmicky on a wedding site.
- Respect prefers-reduced-motion: fall back to simple opacity fades, no parallax or particles.
- Keep parallax displacement under 30px total — this is a solemn, elegant motion language, not a playful scroll-jacking site.

Section 1 of 9

Hero — Couple Names

BACKGROUND

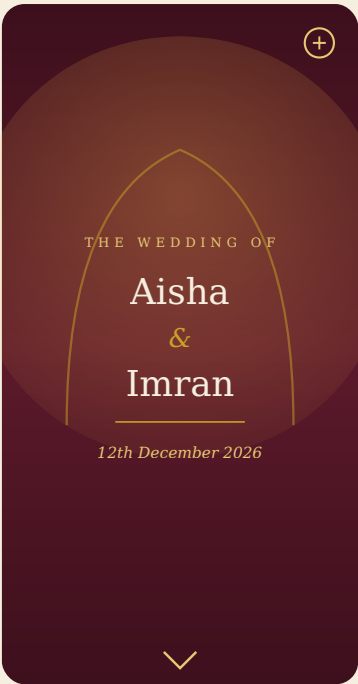
Full-bleed burgundy velvet gradient (deep at top/bottom corners, warmer candle-glow centre). A faint jali lattice pattern overlaid at 6–8% opacity. A large, softly-lit Mughal arch silhouette anchors the composition behind the names — drawn in a slightly lighter burgundy tone so it reads as an embossed architectural frame, not a hard-edged shape.

ELEMENTS

- Small eyebrow label: *"The Wedding Of"* in tracked-out gold caps
- Couple's first names in large Playfair Display, gold-gradient fill, with an ornamental "&" between them (slightly larger, script style)
- Thin gold divider with a small floral/finial motif at centre
- Wedding date in Cormorant italic, e.g. *"Twelfth of December, Two Thousand Twenty-Six"*
- Drifting gold particle motes (low density) throughout the background
- Scroll cue at the bottom: slim lantern icon + soft downward chevron pulse
- Music toggle icon docked top-right corner (persistent across all sections)

ENTRANCE ANIMATION

Continuation of the opening sequence — see page 3. On direct scroll-back to hero, elements simply fade in without staggering (already-seen content).



Hero section wireframe — mobile 375–430px viewport

Sections 2-3 of 9

Countdown Timer & Invitation Message

COUNTDOWN — BACKGROUND

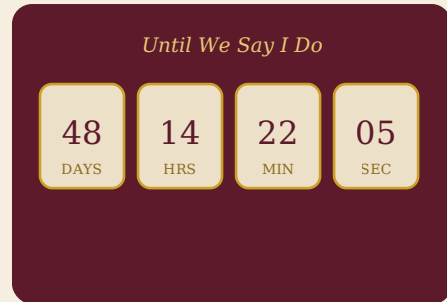
Slightly lighter burgundy than the hero, edge-vignetted, with a very faint radiating "sunburst" of thin gold lines behind the numerals (like light through a lantern's brass lattice).

COUNTDOWN — ELEMENTS

- Small heading: "Until We Say I Do"
- 4 numeral units (Days / Hours / Minutes / Seconds), each inside a small gold-bordered hexagonal or arch-topped medallion on parchment
- Digits in Playfair Display, tabular numerals so they don't jitter in width
- Seconds unit pulses a soft glow on each tick rather than a hard flip, keeping it calm

COUNTDOWN — ANIMATION

Medallions scale/fade in individually left-to-right on entry; digits use a smooth vertical roll/crossfade per tick (never a jarring flip-clock snap).



INVITATION MESSAGE — BACKGROUND

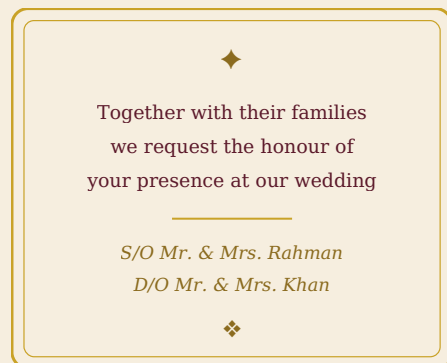
Parchment/ivory card surface (a visual "step out" from the burgundy page background) with a subtle paper-grain texture and a fine double gold border — this is the one section that should feel like a physical printed card rather than a digital panel.

INVITATION MESSAGE — ELEMENTS

- Small calligraphic ornament or corner flourish top-and-bottom
- Formal invitation copy in EB Garamond ("Together with their families... request the honour of your presence...")
- Parents' names in Cormorant italic, smaller and centred
- A closing gold flourish/divider

INVITATION MESSAGE — ANIMATION

The "unfold like a letter" effect described on page 4: card appears to fold open from a horizontal centre crease the first time it's scrolled into view.



Section 4 of 9

Event Schedule

BACKGROUND

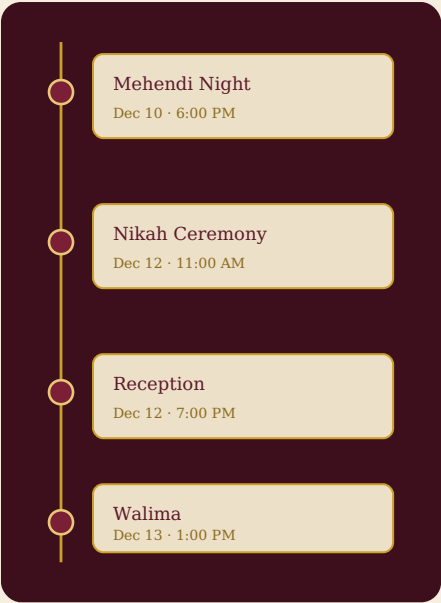
Deep burgundy, with a vertical gold "spine" running down the centre-left as the timeline thread (continues visually from the divider above, per page 4). Very subtle jali texture at low opacity in the negative space to the right of the thread.

ELEMENTS

- Section heading: "*Celebrations*" or "*Wedding Events*"
- Each event as a timeline node: small gold lantern/flame icon marker on the spine, connected to a compact ivory card containing event name, date, time and short note (e.g. Mehendi, Nikah, Reception)
- Cards alternate very slightly in left-padding to avoid a rigid grid feel, while staying single-column for mobile
- An "Add to Calendar" mini-button sits inside each card (see page 9 for full spec)

ANIMATION

The gold spine draws itself downward as the section scrolls into view; each event card fades/slides in from the right shortly after the spine reaches its node, staggered ~150ms apart.



Sections 5–6 of 9

Venue Cards & Google Maps Integration

BACKGROUND

Parchment cards set against the burgundy page background, each framed inside a pointed-arch silhouette (the arch is the card's actual clipped shape at the top edge, not just a decorative overlay) — reinforcing "arriving at a palace gate."

ELEMENTS PER CARD

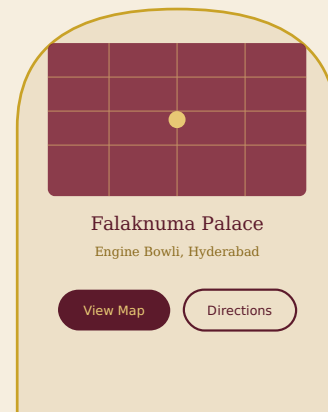
- Venue name in Playfair Display
- Short address line + a small "flag" tag if it differs from the ceremony venue (e.g. "Reception Venue")
- Compact embedded static map thumbnail (styled map — see note below) inside the arch, tap to expand
- Two pill buttons: **"View on Map"** (opens Google Maps app/deep link) and **"Get Directions"**

GOOGLE MAPS INTEGRATION — BUILD NOTE

Use a static Maps Embed (styled with a custom muted/warm JSON map style to match the palette) for the thumbnail — do not load an interactive iFrame map by default, it's heavy. On tap, either deep-link to `google.com/maps` (opens native app on mobile) or expand to a lightweight interactive embed. Always include a plain-text address as fallback.

ANIMATION

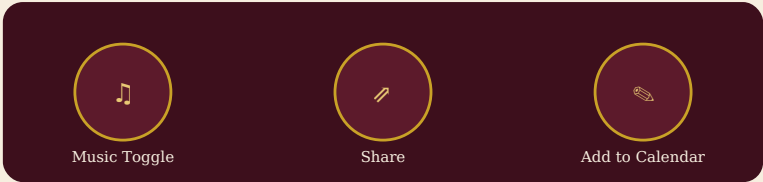
Cards slide in from alternating edges with an arch-shaped clip-path reveal (0%→100% height), per the corridor-archway motion described on page 4.



Sections 7-9 of 9

Background Music, Share & Add to Calendar

BACKGROUND MUSIC TOGGLE A discreet, always-visible gold lantern/note icon Docked top-right corner throughout the whole page (fixed position, floats above content), circular, 40-44px tap target, translucent burgundy glass background with gold ring border. Two states: a soft pulsing glow ring when playing, a static dimmed icon with a subtle line-through when muted. Never autoplay loudly — either require the opening "tap to open" gesture to also start audio (satisfies mobile autoplay policies) or default to muted with a gentle first-time nudge tooltip.	SHARE BUTTON Native share sheet, styled trigger A small gold-outlined circular button (peacock feather or floral-motif icon) fixed near the bottom or inside a closing "RSVP / Share the Joy" section. Triggers the Web Share API on supported mobile browsers (native iOS/Android share sheet); falls back to a custom modal with WhatsApp / copy-link options styled as a small parchment popover with gold border, matching the rest of the UI.
ADD TO CALENDAR Per-event, inline in the schedule Each schedule card (see page 7) carries a small "+ Add to Calendar" text-link with a thin gold underline. Tapping opens a minimal parchment-styled action sheet offering Google Calendar / Apple Calendar / Outlook (.ics download), each row with a small monochrome-gold icon.	CLOSING SECTION "With Love" sign-off Final section mirrors the hero: dark velvet background, a short thank-you script line, small couple monogram, and the share + RSVP actions grouped together as the natural last "room" in the corridor before the page ends on a soft fade to black.



The small touches that sell the "cinematic" feeling

Micro-interactions & UI Components

Component	Default state	Tap / interaction state
Primary pill button (e.g. "View Map")	Solid burgundy fill, gold text, thin gold border	Slight scale-down (0.97) + brief inner glow on press; ripple in gold at 12% opacity
Secondary outline button (e.g. "Directions")	Transparent fill, burgundy border/text	Border fills with a soft gold wash from centre outward on press
Cards (venue / schedule)	Flat parchment with soft drop shadow	On tap: subtle lift (shadow deepens, 2px translateY(-2px)) for 150ms
Music toggle	Static gold ring	Playing: ring pulses softly every 2.4s; note icon gently bobs
Section dividers	Static thin gold line	Draws itself in once per section on scroll entry (see page 4)
Scroll-cue arrow (hero only)	Slow vertical fade/float loop	Fades out permanently once user scrolls past hero

Ornamental asset checklist

- Corner filigree flourish (4-way rotatable), used on invitation card and closing section
- Pointed arch outline (single-stroke SVG), used as venue card mask and hero backdrop
- Jali lattice repeating tile (SVG pattern), used as low-opacity background texture site-wide
- Gold divider motif with centre finial ("❖" style mark), used between every major section
- Lantern/flame icon set (for timeline nodes, scroll cue, calendar rows)
- Wax-seal monogram medallion, used once in the opening animation
- Single decorative calligraphic ornament for the opening sequence only

Keeping it fast, mobile-only, and easy to hand off to a developer

Technical & UX Notes

MOBILE-ONLY LOCK

Design at a fixed max content width (~430px) and centre it with a static burgundy/velvet gutter background on any wider viewport, rather than building a responsive desktop layout — this keeps every animation timing and layout decision exact.

RECOMMENDED STACK

React/Next.js or plain HTML+CSS, with **Framer Motion** or **GSAP** for the opening sequence and scroll reveals, **Lottie** only if a motion designer supplies a particle/flame animation, and native `IntersectionObserver` for scroll triggers.

PERFORMANCE

Keep the opening animation under ~300-400KB total (SVG + small audio file). Lazy-load the venue map thumbnails and any below-the-fold imagery. Preload only the fonts and the first-frame assets needed for the opening sequence.

ACCESSIBILITY

Respect prefers-reduced-motion; ensure all gold-on-burgundy text passes a minimum readable contrast (test body copy specifically — pure gold on burgundy can dip below comfortable contrast, so body text should default to ivory, with gold reserved for large display type).



Suggested build order

- 1 **Design tokens first** — lock the colour palette, type scale, spacing and ornament SVGs as reusable assets/components.
- 2 **Static layout** — build all 9 sections with real content, no animation, to confirm the page reads well at rest.
- 3 **Scroll reveal system** — wire up `IntersectionObserver`-based fade/rise for every section using one shared hook/component.
- 4 **Opening animation last** — build once the rest is stable, since it depends on final hero content and timing feel.
- 5 **Real-device pass** — test the whole sequence on an actual mid-range Android phone at venue-typical network speed before sending to guests.